Hail and Storm Damage Roof Claim Checklist

For Greater Houston homeowners. What to do in the first hours, days and weeks after hail or wind damages your roof.

1. Right after the storm

- [ ] Stay clear of downed power lines and call 911 and your electric provider.
- [ ] Keep people out of rooms where the ceiling is wet or sagging.
- [ ] Stay off the roof. Wet, damaged roofs are slick and can have weak decking.
- [ ] Write down the date and time of the storm, and the size of the hail if you saw it (pea, quarter, golf ball).

2. Document the damage

- [ ] Photograph the roof from the ground on every side, wide shots and zoomed in.
- [ ] Photograph dented gutters, downspouts, roof vents, AC unit fins, window screens, fences and cars. They show hail size and help prove the storm hit your house.
- [ ] Photograph shingles, granules or debris in the yard and at the downspouts.
- [ ] Photograph every ceiling stain, drip and wet spot inside, with the date.
- [ ] Keep a simple log: what you saw, when, and who you spoke with.

3. Stop more damage

- [ ] Put buckets under drips and move belongings out of the way.
- [ ] If the roof is open, have a roofer install an emergency tarp. Most policies expect reasonable steps to prevent further damage.
- [ ] Keep every receipt for emergency repairs, tarps and supplies. They are usually part of the claim.

4. Read your policy before you file

- [ ] Find your wind and hail deductible. In Texas it is often a percentage of your home's insured value, not a flat dollar amount.
- [ ] Check whether the roof is paid at replacement cost or actual cash value.
- [ ] Look for the deadline to report storm damage, and report promptly.
- [ ] On the coast, check whether wind is covered by your homeowners policy or a separate windstorm policy.

5. File the claim

- [ ] Call your insurance company or file online, and write down your claim number.
- [ ] Have a roofer inspect the roof and document the damage before the adjuster visits.
- [ ] Ask the roofer to be on the roof when the adjuster comes, to point out the damage.
- [ ] Get the adjuster's estimate in writing and compare it with the roofer's.

6. Hire carefully

- [ ] Texas does not issue a state license for roofers. Ask for proof of insurance, a local address and references from nearby jobs.
- [ ] Get the scope, the shingle brand and line, the price, the timeline and the workmanship warranty in writing before work starts.
- [ ] Do not pay most of the price upfront.
- [ ] **Under Texas law, a contractor may not pay, waive or rebate your insurance deductible.** Treat any offer to do so as a red flag.
- [ ] The claim is between you and your insurer. A roofer can document damage and meet the adjuster, but should not negotiate the claim on your behalf.
- [ ] Read any agreement a door-to-door roofer asks you to sign after a storm before you sign it, and never sign on the spot under pressure.

7. After the work is done

- [ ] Get the final invoice, the permit and inspection paperwork where your city requires them, and the manufacturer and workmanship warranties.
- [ ] Take photos of the finished roof.
- [ ] If your policy held back part of the payment (recoverable depreciation), send the insurer the paperwork it asks for to release it.
- [ ] If you are replacing the roof, ask your insurer whether impact-resistant (Class 4) shingles earn a premium discount.

Need an inspection? Call **(832) 662-4107** any time and you will be put through to a local, owner-run roofing company. Houston Expert Roofers is a referral service; the roofing company you are connected with inspects, quotes and does the work.

This checklist is general information, not legal or insurance advice. Policies differ; your policy and your insurer have the final word.